THE LAMP AT GULL POINT

written by

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FADE IN:

INT. KITCHEN - DAY

The wind takes the door and slams it. Nobody moves for a long moment. The radio hisses between stations. A kettle starts its long complaint.

Salt has eaten the paint down to the wood. The wind takes the door and slams it. The radio hisses between stations.

JUNE
We said dawn.

KAI
(almost laughing)
We said dawn. I counted them twice.

JUNE
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

KAI
You're late. Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

JUNE
I counted them twice.

KAI
(beat)
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive. Nobody said you were. You're late.

EXT. CLIFF PATH - DUSK

A gull lands on the rail and watches them. He folds the chart twice and pockets it.

The radio hisses between stations. Nobody moves for a long moment.

A gull lands on the rail and watches them. The radio hisses between stations. Rain finds the window and stays. Nobody moves for a long moment.

KAI
You'd like that. I counted them twice. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

MAYA
(beat)
I'd like to come back. We said dawn.
(MORE)

MAYA (CONT'D)
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

KAI
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

MAYA
Get the chart.

KAI
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. Nobody said you were. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

MAYA
(almost laughing)
Get the chart. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. Then count them again.

KAI
The tide won't wait for a speech.

MAYA
I counted them twice. We said dawn. Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

KAI
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. Get the chart.

CUT TO:

INT. LIGHTHOUSE - NIGHT

Nobody moves for a long moment. The radio hisses between stations.

Rain finds the window and stays. The lamp gutters, then holds. Footsteps on the stair, slow, then not.

He folds the chart twice and pockets it. The wind takes the door and slams it. Nobody moves for a long moment.

JUNE (V.O.)
There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. I'd like to come back. You'd like that.

THE CAPTAIN
(almost laughing)
Get the chart. We said dawn. You'd like that.

KAI
Get the chart. You'd like that.

JUNE
You're late.

THE CAPTAIN
I'd like to come back. Then count them again. Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

KAI
(almost laughing)
I'd like to come back. Nobody said you were.

JUNE
There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. You're late. Get the chart.

THE CAPTAIN
The tide won't wait for a speech. Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

KAI
Get the chart.

EXT. HARBOUR - DAWN

Footsteps on the stair, slow, then not. She counts the boats and comes up one short.

He folds the chart twice and pockets it. Somewhere below, the engine turns over and dies. Nobody moves for a long moment.

MAYA
Nobody said you were. It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

KAI
(to the window)
Nobody said you were.

MAYA
Then count them again. Nobody said you were. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

KAI
Nobody said you were. I counted them twice. The tide won't wait for a speech.

MAYA
The tide won't wait for a speech.

KAI
(quietly)
You'd like that.

MAYA
Now.

KAI
Later.

CUT TO:

INT. CAPTAIN'S CABIN - CONTINUOUS

Rain finds the window and stays. A gull lands on the rail and watches them. A kettle starts its long complaint. The wind takes the door and slams it.

He folds the chart twice and pockets it. The radio hisses between stations.

KAI
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. The tide won't wait for a speech.

MAYA
(beat)
You'd like that. It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

KAI
Nobody said you were. I'd like to come back.

MAYA
We said dawn. Get the chart.

KAI
Nobody said you were. You're late. I counted them twice.

MAYA
(beat)
Get the chart.

KAI
We said dawn.

EXT. BEACH - DAY

Rain finds the window and stays. The radio hisses between stations. Nobody moves for a long moment. The lamp gutters, then holds.

JUNE
We said dawn.

MAYA
(quietly)
Nobody said you were. The tide won't wait for a speech. Then count them again.

THE CAPTAIN
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

JUNE
We said dawn. I'd like to come back.

MAYA
Get the chart. I'd like to come back.

THE CAPTAIN
(almost laughing)
We said dawn. The tide won't wait for a speech.

JUNE
I'd like to come back.

MAYA
I'd like to come back. Then count them again.

THE CAPTAIN
I'd like to come back. The tide won't wait for a speech.

THE SAME SEA

CUT TO:

INT. CHAPEL - NIGHT

The lamp gutters, then holds. Rain finds the window and stays. The radio hisses between stations. The wind takes the door and slams it.

OLD TOM
You'd like that. We said dawn.

MAYA
(to the window)
There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. The tide won't wait for a speech. I'd like to come back.

OLD TOM
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

MAYA
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. I counted them twice.

OLD TOM
I counted them twice. I'd like to come back. Nobody said you were.

MAYA
(quietly)
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

OLD TOM
There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up. You're late.

MAYA
Then count them again.

OLD TOM
Then count them again. I counted them twice.

I/E. TRUCK - DAY

The lamp gutters, then holds. Footsteps on the stair, slow, then not. Nobody moves for a long moment. She counts the boats and comes up one short.

She counts the boats and comes up one short. Somewhere below, the engine turns over and dies.

OLD TOM
I counted them twice. Get the chart.

JUNE
(beat)
You'd like that. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

OLD TOM
We said dawn. You'd like that. I'd like to come back.

JUNE
I'd like to come back. I counted them twice.

OLD TOM
The tide won't wait for a speech. Nobody said you were.

JUNE
(to the window)
I'd like to come back.

Row, row, the lamp is low

CUT TO:

INT. RADIO ROOM - LATER

Footsteps on the stair, slow, then not. Rain finds the window and stays.

Rain finds the window and stays. The wind takes the door and slams it.

Salt has eaten the paint down to the wood. Somewhere below, the engine turns over and dies.

THE CAPTAIN
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive. Get the chart. There was a light on the water. I'm not making it up.

OLD TOM
(quietly)
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. The tide won't wait for a speech. You're late.

KAI
I'd like to come back.

THE CAPTAIN
We said dawn. It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. The tide won't wait for a speech.

OLD TOM
I counted them twice. I'd like to come back.

KAI
(beat)
I counted them twice. Then count them again.

EXT. CLIFF PATH - NIGHT

A gull lands on the rail and watches them. The radio hisses between stations. He folds the chart twice and pockets it.

The wind takes the door and slams it. The lamp gutters, then holds.

A kettle starts its long complaint. Salt has eaten the paint down to the wood. The radio hisses between stations.

OLD TOM
The tide won't wait for a speech. It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. I'd like to come back.

KAI
(beat)
The tide won't wait for a speech. Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive.

OLD TOM
The tide won't wait for a speech.

KAI
The tide won't wait for a speech.

OLD TOM
Then we go by the stars like my father did, and his father, and we come back wet and alive. We said dawn.

KAI
(beat)
You'd like that. It's gone. The whole drawer is gone.

OLD TOM
It's gone. The whole drawer is gone. Get the chart. We said dawn.

KAI
You're late. I counted them twice. You'd like that.

CUT TO:

FADE OUT.